



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

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Let's Start!

I need to take some time off!



Learning Outcome

Describe characteristics of different people and their jobs in common social situations.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about jobs and work.
- I can talk about current actions and states.
- I can ask for clarification.

Ask your partner:

- Who is your boss?
- Do you ask for time off?
- Is it easy or hard to take time off?
Why?





Let's Explore!

Vanessa is calling her boss. Will she get her days off?



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Mr. Johnson: Hello?

Vanessa: Hello? Mr. Johnson?

Mr. Johnson: Hello Vanessa. How are you?

Vanessa: I'm fine, Mr. Johnson. A friend of mine is visiting from Cambridge. I'm calling to ask for a few days off in the next few days.

Mr. Johnson: What do you mean by days off?

Vanessa: I'm hoping I can use some vacation time next week.

Mr. Johnson: Well, Vanessa, you just started in your new position as sous-chef a few weeks ago.

Vanessa: Yes, Mr. Johnson, but I have three weeks of vacation left.

Mr. Johnson: You must earn those days off, Vanessa.

Vanessa: Could you be more explicit?

Mr. Johnson: Well, you will have 3 weeks holiday at the end of your first year.

Vanessa: Oh, I didn't realize that.

Mr. Johnson: Yes, but your benefit plan allows you to take 3 personal days during the year. You can use those days if your head chef agrees.

Vanessa: Oh, thank you Mr. Johnson! You're a great boss!

Mr. Johnson: I'm just a good manager.





Let's Practice!

Vanessa and her boss ask for clarification.

Instructions: Practice reading the sentences aloud.

1. Could you clarify that, please?
2. What do you mean by time off?
3. Do you mean I can't take a vacation?
4. Could you be more explicit about that?
5. Could you give me an example?



Let's Practice!

Is it a bird? Is it a plane? Is it a person?

Instructions: Write the words in the correct category.

Position
Personal days
Sous-chef
Boss

Head chef
Manager
Benefit plan
Health insurance

A Person

Not a Person



Extension Activity

Write a dialogue asking your boss for time off.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Write a dialogue of 7 to 9 lines. One person is the worker. The other person is the boss or manager.
- Ask for time off.
- Use expressions asking for clarification.
- Practice your dialogue with a partner.
- Change roles.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I write 9 lines about a boss and a worker.

☐ ☐

I ask for clarification in a dialogue.

☐ ☐

I practice speaking with a partner.

☐ ☐

I change roles in a dialogue.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **to earn** (verb): to obtain after doing something
e.g. You must earn those days off.
- **holiday** (noun): vacation; time you do not work
e.g. You will have 3 weeks for a holiday at the end of your first year.
- **benefit plan** (noun): extra advantages connected to a job, like health insurance
e.g. Your benefit plan includes personal days and health insurance.
- **personal day** (noun): a day you do not work, you do other things (but not vacation)
e.g. You can take three personal days during the year.
- **head chef** (noun): the person who is responsible for the kitchen in a restaurant
e.g. You can use those days if your head chef agrees.
- **manager** (noun): a person who organizes the work of other people
e.g. I'm just a good manager.
- **boss** (noun): the person who is in charge of a workplace
e.g. Thank you Mr. Johnson! You're a great boss!





Learning Points

Simple Present vs. Present Continuous Tenses

You use the Simple Present tense to talk about:

- a routine action or specific action that happens regularly
- a general truth
- to give personal information

You can use expressions of frequency like *every day* or *always* with the Present Simple.

You form the Present Continuous with the verb **to be + verb-ing**.

You use the Present Continuous tense to talk about:

- a current event or action happening around now
- events that **are going to happen** soon (future plans)

You can use expressions like *right now* or *later* with the Present Continuous.

Present Tense	Present Continuous Tense
<i>I have three weeks of vacation left.</i>	<i>I am calling to ask for a few days off.</i>
<i>Your benefit plan allows you to take 3 personal days during the year.</i>	<i>I am hoping I can use some vacation time next week.</i>

Asking for Clarification

If you don't understand what a person is saying, it is important to ask for clarification in a polite way.

Here are some expressions you can use to ask for clarification.

- Could you clarify what you mean by that?
- What do you mean by ... ?
- Do you mean ... ?
- Could you be more explicit about that?
- Could you give me an example?

